

FOSS CLUB PRESENTS

UI ARENA

The UI Clone Challenge

Git & GitHub Starter Guide

A beginner-friendly, no-prior-experience-needed walkthrough of every Git step you'll need on for the competition — from forking the repository to opening your submission Pull Request.

ORGANIZED BY
FOSS Club

DATE
8 August 2026

FORMAT
Online · Individual

Keep this PDF open during the challenge — copy-paste the commands as you go.

Why this guide?

UI ARENA is submitted entirely through GitHub — you fork a repository, build your UI, and open a Pull Request (PR) before the deadline. This guide walks through every Git step you'll need on event day, from forking the repo to understanding how merging works. Work through it once before the event so the workflow feels familiar when the clock starts.

The big picture



Only **you** control the first five steps. Merge happens after the event, when organizers review submissions.

Before you start

- Create a free GitHub account at **github.com** if you don't already have one.
- Install Git on your system (**git-scm.com**) — check with `git --version` in your terminal.
- Have a code editor ready (VS Code recommended).
- Attend the pre-event orientation session — we'll do a live walkthrough of everything below.

1 Fork the repository

A fork creates your own copy of the official UI ARENA repository under your GitHub account. This copy is where all your work will live — you can experiment freely without affecting the original.

- 1 Open the repository link shared at event kick-off.
- 2 Click the **Fork** button in the top-right corner of the GitHub page.
- 3 Confirm your account as the destination. GitHub creates `your-username/repo-name`.

TIP

You now have a personal copy at `github.com/your-username/repo-name`

2 Clone it to your computer

Cloning downloads your forked repository from GitHub onto your local machine so you can edit files in your own editor.

On your fork's page, click **Code** → copy the HTTPS URL. Then in your terminal:

```
git clone https://github.com/your-username/repo-name.git
cd repo-name
```

This creates a folder with all the project files, ready to open in your editor.

3 Create a branch

Recommended, not mandatory

Branches keep your changes organized and separate from the main version. It's good practice, though not mandatory for this event.

```
git checkout -b my-submission
```

4 Make changes & commit

Build the UI as you normally would in your editor. Once you've made progress, save it as a commit — a snapshot of your work with a short message describing what changed.

```
git add .  
git commit -m "Add homepage layout and navbar"
```

GOOD PRACTICE

Commit often — after finishing a section, a component, or a fix. Small, frequent commits with clear messages make your work easier to review and are part of good code quality.

5 Push to your fork

Pushing uploads your local commits back to your fork on GitHub, so your work is backed up and visible online.

```
git push origin my-submission
```

The first time you push a new branch, GitHub may show a link in the terminal to open a Pull Request directly — you can use it or follow Step 6 manually.

6 Open a Pull Request (PR)

A Pull Request is how you formally submit your work — it asks the organizers' repository to “pull in” your changes for review. This is your official submission for UI ARENA.

- 1 Go to your fork on GitHub. You'll usually see a banner: “Compare & pull request.” Click it.
- 2 If you don't see the banner, go to the **Pull Requests** tab → **New Pull Request**.
- 3 Check the base repository is the official UI ARENA repo, and the compare branch is yours.
- 4 Give it a clear title (e.g., your name or username) and, if useful, a short description of your approach.
- 5 Click **Create Pull Request**.

WATCH OUT

That's it — your PR is your submission. Only PRs opened **within the event window** will be considered, so don't leave this step for the last minute.

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Merging

What happens next

Merging is the final step where your Pull Request's changes are combined into the main project. For UI ARENA, this is handled by the organizers during judging — you don't need to merge anything yourself. It's still worth understanding, since it's how real-world open-source contributions work:

- A reviewer looks at your PR's changes.
- If everything looks good, they click **Merge Pull Request**, and your code becomes part of the main repository.
- If there are conflicts (two people edited the same lines), Git will flag them for manual resolution — this is called a **merge conflict**.

Quick reference: all commands

Step	Command	What it does
Clone	<code>git clone</code>	Download your fork to your computer
Check status	<code>git status</code>	See what's changed and staged
Create branch	<code>git checkout -b</code>	Start a new branch for your work
Stage changes	<code>git add .</code>	Mark all edited files for the next commit
Commit	<code>git commit -m "message"</code>	Save a snapshot with a description
Push	<code>git push origin</code>	Upload commits to your GitHub fork
View history	<code>git log --oneline</code>	See a short list of past commits
Pull updates	<code>git pull</code>	Fetch and merge the latest changes

Common beginner mistakes to avoid

- ✗ Cloning the original repo instead of your fork — always copy the URL from your own forked copy, not the organizers' repo.
- ✗ Forgetting to push — commits made locally aren't visible on GitHub, and therefore not part of your PR, until you push.
- ✗ Opening the PR against the wrong branch — double-check the base repository is the official UI ARENA repo before submitting.
- ✗ One giant commit at the very end — commit in small stages throughout the day; it's safer and reflects better code quality.
- ✗ Waiting until the last few minutes to open the PR — only PRs created within the event window count, so leave buffer time.

Need help?

Ask your event coordinators regarding any issues faced by the participant and feel free to share your worries to us. Hope you have fun in this hackathon. All the best everyone